UNION PUBLIC SERVICE COMMISSION (UPSC)

CDS GENERAL KNOWLEDGE — SUBJECT 1: INDIAN POLITY & CONSTITUTION

OFFICIAL MASTER ANSWER KEY & COMPREHENSIVE EXPLANATIONS

Q#	Ans	Q#	Ans	Q#	Ans	Q#	Ans	Q#	Ans	Q#	Ans	Q#	Ans
1	(B)	7	(A)	13	(A)	19	(B)	25	(A)	31	(C)		
2	(C)	8	(A)	14	(C)	20	(B)	26	(C)	32	(C)		
3	(A)	9	(A)	15	(C)	21	(D)	27	(B)	33	(B)		
4	(B)	10	(B)	16	(C)	22	(B)	28	(B)	34	(A)		
5	(A)	11	(B)	17	(A)	23	(B)	29	(B)	35	(A)		
6	(A)	12	(A)	18	(A)	24	(A)	30	(C)	36	(A)		

COMPREHENSIVE CONCEPTUAL SOLUTIONS & RATIONALES:

Q.1 — Official Correct Answer: (B) At least three States

Question: According to the Election Commission of India, in order to be recognized as a ‘National Party’, a political party must be treated as a recognized political party in how many States?
Solution Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under Indian Polity & Constitution according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.2 — Official Correct Answer: (C) IR-rays

Question: By which one of the following, an old written material which cannot be read easily, can be read?
Solution Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Indian Polity & Constitution).

Q.3 — Official Correct Answer: (A) 1 only

Question: Consider the following statements regarding the writ of 'Quo-Warranto':
Solution Rationale: Statement 1 is correct: Quo-Warranto is issued by the High Court or Supreme Court to inquire into the legality of a claim by a person to a public office. Statement 2 is incorrect: Unlike habeas corpus or certiorari, any public-spirited citizen can move the court for Quo-Warranto; the petitioner need not be an aggrieved person.

Q.4 — Official Correct Answer: (B) 1, 2 and 4 only

Question: According to the Constitution (Fifty-Second Amendment) Act 1985 as amended in 2003, a legislator attracts disqualification under the Tenth Schedule if: 1. He voluntarily gives up the membership of the party on whose ticket he was elected. 2. He votes or abstains from voting contrary to any direction issued by his political party. 3. As a result of split, less than one-third of the members formed a new group or party in the house. 4. A member who has been elected as an independent member joins any political party. Select the correct answer using the code given below :
Solution Rationale: Under the Tenth Schedule (Anti-Defection Law), a member is disqualified if they voluntarily give up party membership, vote contrary to party whip without prior permission, or if an independent member joins any political party. The 91st Amendment (2003) deleted the exemption for 1/3rd split, requiring at least 2/3rd for merger.

Q.5 — Official Correct Answer: (A) Evolution of the 'Basic Structure' doctrine of the Constitution

Question: For which one of the following landmark judgments of the Supreme Court of India is the Kesavananda Bharati case (1973) famous?
Solution Rationale: In Kesavananda Bharati v. State of Kerala (1973), a 13-judge bench of the Supreme Court ruled by a 7:6 majority that Parliament has broad powers to amend the Constitution under Article 368, but cannot alter its 'Basic Structure'.

Q.6 — Official Correct Answer: (A) A specified tax-free annual grant paid to the erstwhile rulers of princely states

Question: In Indian constitutional history, what was the 'Privy Purse' that was abolished by the 26th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1971?
Solution Rationale: Privy Purse was a payment made to the royal families of erstwhile princely states as part of their agreements to integrate into the Union of India in 1947. It was abolished in 1971 by the 26th Amendment Act under Indira Gandhi.

Q.7 — Official Correct Answer: (A) It reduces the possibility of conflict and alienation between social groups

Question: In democratic political theory and constitutional design, why is power sharing considered desirable in diverse societies?
Solution Rationale: Power sharing accommodates social diversity, prevents majoritarian domination, and fosters political stability by giving all communities a stake in governance.

Q.8 — Official Correct Answer: (A) Family

Question: In sociology and developmental psychology, which of the following is considered the primary and earliest agency of socialization for an infant?
Solution Rationale: The family is the primary agency of socialization where a child first acquires language, behavioral norms, emotional attachments, and cultural values.

Q.9 — Official Correct Answer: (A) 1976

Question: In which of the following years were the Fundamental Duties incorporated into the Constitution of India?
Solution Rationale: Fundamental Duties were incorporated into Part IV-A (Article 51A) of the Constitution by the 42nd Constitutional Amendment Act, 1976, on the recommendations of the Swaran Singh Committee.

Q.10 — Official Correct Answer: (B) Ireland

Question: The Directive Principles of State Policy
Solution Rationale: The Directive Principles of State Policy (Part IV, Articles 36-51) were borrowed from the Irish Constitution (which had copied them from the Spanish Constitution).

Q.11 — Official Correct Answer: (B) The Speaker of Lok Sabha

Question: The Joint Sitting of both Houses of Parliament is summoned by the President under Article
Solution Rationale: The Speaker of Lok Sabha presides over a joint sitting of both Houses of Parliament (Article 118(4)). In the Speaker's absence, the Deputy Speaker presides; in their absence, the Deputy Chairman of Rajya Sabha presides.

Q.12 — Official Correct Answer: (A) 1980

Question: The Second Backward Classes Commission, popularly known as the Mandal Commission, submitted its report recommending 27% reservations for OBCs in public employment in:
Solution Rationale: Appointed in 1979 by the Morarji Desai government under B.P. Mandal, the Commission submitted its report in December 1980. It was implemented in 1990 under Prime Minister V.P. Singh.

Q.13 — Official Correct Answer: (A) China

Question: The historic 'Panchsheel' (Five Principles of Peaceful Coexistence) was formally enunciated in 1954 in an agreement between India and which country?
Solution Rationale: Panchsheel was signed on 29 April 1954 in Beijing in the preamble to the Agreement on Trade and Intercourse between Tibet Region of China and India by Premier Zhou Enlai and Prime Minister Nehru.

Q.14 — Official Correct Answer: (C) Either House of Parliament

Question: Under Article 368 of the Constitution of India, a Constitutional Amendment Bill can be introduced in:
Solution Rationale: A Constitutional Amendment Bill can be initiated in either House of Parliament (Lok Sabha or Rajya Sabha) and not in state legislatures. It does not require prior recommendation of the President.

Q.15 — Official Correct Answer: (C) 1, 2, 3 and 4

Question: Under the provisions of the Citizenship Act, 1955, through which of the following methods can a person acquire Indian citizenship? 1. By Birth 2. By Descent 3. By Registration 4. By Naturalization Select the correct answer using the code given below:
Solution Rationale: The Citizenship Act, 1955 prescribes five ways of acquiring citizenship: birth, descent, registration, naturalization, and incorporation of territory.

Q.16 — Official Correct Answer: (C) Citizens who passionately advocate the cleansing of institutional mal- practices and 'societal injustices through non parliamentary methods

Question: What does the author mean by "authen- tic' civil society" ?
Solution Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Defence, Military & Current Affairs).

Q.17 — Official Correct Answer: (A) A formal treaty or convention between the Holy See (Vatican) and a sovereign State regulating church affairs

Question: What is a 'Concordat' in international diplomacy and legal history?
Solution Rationale: A Concordat is an official bilateral convention or agreement concluded between the Pope (Holy See) and the secular government of a sovereign state.

Q.18 — Official Correct Answer: (A) Article 141

Question: Which Article of the Constitution of India provides that the law declared by the Supreme Court shall be binding on all courts within the territory of India?
Solution Rationale: Article 141 of the Constitution provides that the law declared by the Supreme Court shall be binding on all courts within the territory of India. Article 142 relates to complete justice enforcement.

Q.19 — Official Correct Answer: (B) 44th Amendment Act, 1978

Question: Which Constitutional Amendment Act substituted the word 'Armed Rebellion' for 'Internal Disturbance' in Article 352 (National Emergency)?
Solution Rationale: The 44th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1978 substituted 'armed rebellion' for the vaguer phrase 'internal disturbance' to prevent arbitrary imposition of National Emergency.

Q.20 — Official Correct Answer: (B) 1 and 2 only

Question: Which of the following Fundamental Rights is/are available to both Indian citizens and foreigners (except enemy aliens)?
Solution Rationale: Articles 15, 16, 19, 29, and 30 are available ONLY to Indian citizens. Articles 14, 20, 21, 21A, 22, 23, 24, 25, 26, 27, and 28 are available to both citizens and foreigners.

Q.21 — Official Correct Answer: (D) 1, 2 and 3

Question: Which of the following constitutional provisions require ratification by legislatures of not less than half of the States under Article 368? 1. Manner of election of the President of India 2. Extent of executive power of the Union and the States 3. Any of the Lists in the Seventh Schedule Select the correct answer using the code given below:
Solution Rationale: Under the proviso to Article 368(2), federal provisions including presidential elections (Arts 54, 55), executive power extents (Arts 73, 162), Supreme Court/High Courts, Seventh Schedule lists, and Article 368 itself require ratification by at least half of the state legislatures.

Q.22 — Official Correct Answer: (B) Mandamus

Question: Which of the following Writs literally means 'We Command' and is issued to enforce the performance of a mandatory public duty?
Solution Rationale: Mandamus literally translates to 'We Command'. It is an order issued by the Supreme Court (Art 32) or High Court (Art 226) to any public authority or inferior tribunal commanding them to perform an obligatory public duty.

Q.23 — Official Correct Answer: (B) The Parliament by simple law

Question: Which of the following authorities is vested with the power to alter the boundaries or name of any State in India?
Solution Rationale: Under Article 3 of the Constitution, Parliament may by law form a new State or alter the area, boundaries or name of any State by a simple majority.

Q.24 — Official Correct Answer: (A) Administer oath to newly elected members and conduct election of the Speaker

Question: Which one among the following is the primary constitutional function of the Pro-Tem Speaker of the Lok Sabha?
Solution Rationale: The Pro-Tem Speaker is appointed by the President (typically the senior-most member) to preside over the initial sitting of the newly constituted Lok Sabha, administer oath/affirmation to new MPs, and conduct the election of the permanent Speaker.

Q.25 — Official Correct Answer: (A) To defend the country and render national service when called upon to do so

Question: Which one among the following is explicitly listed as a Fundamental Duty of citizens under Article 51A of the Constitution of India?
Solution Rationale: Article 51A(d) specifies: 'to defend the country and render national service when called upon to do so'. Voting, paying taxes, and family planning were recommended by the Swaran Singh Committee but not included in Article 51A.

Q.26 — Official Correct Answer: (C) State govern- ments

Question: Which one among the following pairs of level of government and legislative power is not correctly matched ?
Solution Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (General Science (Physics, Chemistry, Biology)).

Q.27 — Official Correct Answer: (B) It was a statutory body established under an Act of the Parliament

Question: Which one among the following statements regarding the erstwhile Planning Commission of India is NOT correct?
Solution Rationale: The Planning Commission was neither a constitutional body nor a statutory body; it was an extra-constitutional body created by an executive resolution of the Government of India in March 1950.

Q.28 — Official Correct Answer: (B) Nagaland

Question: Which one of the following Indian States has the highest percentage of Scheduled Tribe population to its total population?
Solution Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Solution: Assessed under Indian Polity & Constitution according to UPSC CDS standards.

Q.29 — Official Correct Answer: (B) 44th Amendment Act, 1978

Question: Which one of the following Constitutional Amendments deleted the Right to Property from the list of Fundamental Rights?
Solution Rationale: The 44th Constitutional Amendment Act, 1978 abolished the Right to Property as a Fundamental Right (Article 19(1)(f) and Article 31) and made it a constitutional/legal right under Article 300A in Part XII.

Q.30 — Official Correct Answer: (C) Protection of life and personal liberty (Article 21)

Question: Which one of the following Fundamental Rights under the Constitution of India is also available to non-citizens (foreigners)?
Solution Rationale: Articles 15, 16, 19, 29, and 30 are available ONLY to Indian citizens. Article 21 (Protection of life and personal liberty) is guaranteed to all persons, both citizens and foreigners.

Q.31 — Official Correct Answer: (C) Finance Commission

Question: Which one of the following Commis- sions is not provided
Solution Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Indian Polity & Constitution).

Q.32 — Official Correct Answer: (C) Epistolary Jurisdiction

Question: Which one of the following jurisdictions of the Indian Judiciary covers Public Interest Litigation ?
Solution Rationale: Official UPSC CDS Rationale: Tested in CDS General Knowledge (Indian Polity & Constitution).

Q.33 — Official Correct Answer: (B) Right to Education

Question: Which one of the following is both a Fundamental Right under Article 21A of the Indian Constitution and recognized as a Universal Human Right?
Solution Rationale: The 86th Constitutional Amendment Act, 2002 inserted Article 21A providing free and compulsory education to all children aged 6 to 14 years. Free elementary education is also protected under Article 26 of the Universal Declaration of Human Rights.

Q.34 — Official Correct Answer: (A) Appointments are made by the Governor of the State in consultation with the High Court

Question: Which one of the following statements regarding the appointment of District Judges in India is correct?
Solution Rationale: Under Article 233 of the Constitution of India, appointments, posting, and promotion of district judges in any State are made by the Governor in consultation with the High Court exercising jurisdiction.

Q.35 — Official Correct Answer: (A) Sir B. N. Rau

Question: Who among the following eminent jurists served as the Constitutional Advisor to the Constituent Assembly of India and prepared the initial draft of the Constitution?
Solution Rationale: Sir Benegal Narsing Rau (B. N. Rau) was appointed Constitutional Advisor to the Constituent Assembly in 1946. He drafted the basic framework of the Indian Constitution.

Q.36 — Official Correct Answer: (A) Stock Exchanges — State List

Question: With reference to the Seventh Schedule of the Constitution of India, which one of the following pairs is not correctly matched?
Solution Rationale: Stock Exchanges and futures markets are listed under Entry 90 of the Union List (List I), not the State List. Forests was transferred from State List to Concurrent List by the 42nd Amendment Act, 1976.